

Word family: **weak / weaker / weakest / weakly / weakness / weaken**

Base word: weak

Comparative: weaker

Superlative: weakest

Part of speech: mainly **adjective**

Related forms:

* **weak** (adj.) — 弱的；虛弱的；薄弱的；不強的

* **weakly** (adv.) — 虛弱地；無力地

* **weakness** (n.) — 弱點；虛弱；弱勢

* **weaken** (v.) — 削弱；變弱

Useful expressions / extensions:

* **weak student**

* **weak person**

* **weak muscles**

* **weak voice**

* **weak argument**

* **weak evidence**

* **weak performance**

* **weak economy**

* **weak currency**

* **weak signal**

* **weak light**

* **weak tea / coffee**

* **weak point**

* **weakness**

* **weaken someone's position**

* **be weak at something**

* **have a weakness for something**

Meaning in this passage

> He did not show off, and he never made **weaker students** feel small.

Here, **weaker students** means:

students who were less academically strong or less capable in the subject — 能力較弱的學生；成績較弱的學生

The speaker is not saying the students were physically weak.

****中文翻譯：****

他不會責弄自己，也從不令****能力較弱的學生****覺得自己很差。

So here:

****weaker students = 在學業表現、理解能力或科目能力上較弱的學生****

1. ****weak student (能力 / 學業較弱的學生) — 能力較弱的；成績較弱的****

This is the meaning used in your passage.

Practice 1 — original sentence

> He never made ****weaker students**** feel small.

他從不令****能力較弱的學生****覺得自己很差。

Practice 2

> The teacher gave extra support to ****weaker students****.

老師給予****能力較弱的學生****額外支援。

Practice 3

> She was ****weak in mathematics**** but strong in languages.

她的數學****較弱****，但語言能力很強。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****weak = 在某項能力、科目或表現上低於平均水平的****

2. ****be weak at/in something — 在某方面較弱****

Practice 1

> I'm ****weak at spelling****.

我的拼字****比較弱****。

Practice 2

> He is **weak** in science.

他的科學科**比較弱**。

MCQ-ready definition:

be weak at/in something = 在某個技能、學科或能力方面表現較差

3. **weak** (身體虛弱的) — 虛弱的 ; 無力的

A major literal sense.

Practice 1

> She felt **weak** after being ill.

她病後感到很**虛弱**。

Practice 2

> His legs were too **weak** to support him.

他的雙腿太**無力**，支撐不了身體。

MCQ-ready definition:

weak = 身體缺乏力量、體力或能量的

4. **weak muscles / body** — 肌肉 / 身體無力

Practice 1

> Regular exercise can strengthen **weak muscles**.

定期運動可以強化**無力的肌肉**。

Practice 2

> His body was still **weak** after the operation.

手術後他的身體仍然很**虛弱**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****weak muscles/body = 缺乏足夠力量或耐力的身體 / 肌肉****

5. ****weak voice — 微弱 / 無力的聲音****

Practice 1

> She answered in a ****weak voice****.

她用****虛弱的聲音****回答。

Practice 2

> His voice sounded ****weak and tired****.

他的聲音聽起來****無力而疲倦****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****weak voice = 音量、力量或精神不足的聲音****

6. ****weak signal — 微弱訊號****

Practice 1

> The phone has a ****weak signal**** here.

這裏的手機****訊號很弱****。

Practice 2

> We lost the connection because of a ****weak signal****.

因為****訊號太弱****，我們失去了連線。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****weak signal = 強度低、不穩定或難以接收的訊號****

7. ****weak light — 微弱光線****

Practice 1

> A **weak light** came through the window.

窗外透進一點**微弱的光線**。

Practice 2

> The lamp gave off a **weak glow**.

那盞燈發出**微弱的光**。

MCQ-ready definition:

weak light = 亮度很低、光線不強的光

8. **weak argument** — 薄弱的論點

A major abstract sense.

Practice 1

> That's a **weak argument**.

那是一個很**薄弱的論點**。

Practice 2

> His argument was **weak** because it lacked evidence.

他的論點很**薄弱**，因為缺乏證據。

MCQ-ready definition:

weak argument = 理據不足、說服力低的論點

9. **weak evidence** — 薄弱證據

Practice 1

> The claim is based on **weak evidence**.

這個說法建立在**薄弱的證據**上。

Practice 2

> The case against him was **weak**.

針對他的證據**很薄弱**。

MCQ-ready definition:

weak evidence = 數量少、可靠性低或不足以有力支持結論的證據

10. **weak explanation / excuse — 牽強的解釋 / 藉口**

Practice 1

> That was a **weak excuse**.

那是一個很**牽強的藉口**。

Practice 2

> Her explanation sounded **weak**.

她的解釋聽起來很**站不住腳**。

MCQ-ready definition:

weak explanation/excuse = 缺乏可信理由或說服力的解釋 / 藉口

11. **weak performance — 表現欠佳**

Practice 1

> The team gave a **weak performance**.

球隊的**表現很差**。

Practice 2

> Sales were **weak** this month.

本月銷售**表現疲弱**。

MCQ-ready definition:

weak performance = 表現低於正常或理想水平

12. **weak economy / market — 疲弱的經濟 / 市場**

Practice 1

> The country is facing a **weak economy**.

這個國家正面對**疲弱的經濟**。

Practice 2

> Consumer demand remained **weak**.

消費需求仍然**疲弱**。

MCQ-ready definition:

weak economy/market/demand = 活動、增長或需求水平偏低

13. **weak currency — 疲弱貨幣；匯價低的貨幣**

Practice 1

> A **weak currency** can make imports more expensive.

疲弱的貨幣會令進口貨更昂貴。

Practice 2

> The currency remained **weak** against the dollar.

該貨幣兌美元仍然**偏弱**。

MCQ-ready definition:

weak currency = 相對其他貨幣價值較低或正在貶值的貨幣

14. **weak tea / coffee — 淡茶 / 淡咖啡**

Practice 1

> I prefer **weak tea**.

我比較喜歡**淡茶**。

Practice 2

> This coffee is too **weak**.

這杯咖啡太**淡**。

MCQ-ready definition:

weak tea/coffee = 味道或濃度不強的飲品

15. **weak colour / flavour — 淡的顏色 / 味道**

Practice 1

> The sauce has a rather **weak flavour**.

這個醬汁的味道比較**淡**。

Practice 2

> The colour looks **weak** under this light.

這種顏色在這個光線下看起來有點**淡**。

MCQ-ready definition:

weak flavour/colour = 強度、濃度或鮮明程度較低

16. **weak point — 弱點；缺點**

A very common expression.

Practice 1

> Grammar is my **weak point**.

文法是我的**弱項**。

Practice 2

> Every plan has a **weak point**.

每個計劃都有**弱點**。

MCQ-ready definition:

weak point = 某人、計劃或系統中最容易出問題、表現較差的部分

17. **weakness** (弱點 ; 缺點) — 弱點 ; 缺點

Practice 1

> His main **weakness** is poor time management.

他主要的**弱點**是時間管理差。

Practice 2

> The plan has several **weaknesses**.

這個計劃有幾個**弱點**。

MCQ-ready definition:

weakness = 缺乏力量、能力或有效性的地方

18. **weakness** (身體虛弱) — 虛弱 ; 無力

Practice 1

> She felt sudden **weakness** in her legs.

她突然感到雙腿**無力**。

Practice 2

> The illness caused severe **weakness**.

疾病令她非常**虛弱**。

MCQ-ready definition:

weakness = 身體缺乏力量或體力的狀態

19. **have a weakness for something** — 特別喜愛 ; 難以抗拒

A very useful figurative expression.

Practice 1

> I have a **weakness for chocolate**.

我對朱古力**特別沒有抵抗力 / 特別喜歡**。

Practice 2

> She has a **weakness for old bookstores**.

她對舊書店**情有獨鍾**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****have a weakness for something = 特別喜歡某物，往往很難抗拒****

20. **weaken something — 削弱某物**

Practice 1

> The damage **weakened the structure**.

損壞**削弱了結構**。

Practice 2

> The argument was **weakened by a lack of evidence**.

由於缺乏證據，這個論點的說服力被**削弱**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****weaken something = 令某物失去部分力量、效果或影響力****

21. **weaken (變弱) — 變弱；減弱**

Practice 1

> The storm began to **weaken**.

風暴開始**減弱**。

Practice 2

> Demand has **weakened** in recent months.

近幾個月需求已經**轉弱**。

MCQ-ready definition:

weaken = 力量、強度、效果或表現下降

22. **weaken** someone's position / argument — 削弱立場 / 論點

Practice 1

> The new evidence **weakened** his position.

新證據**削弱**了他的立場。

Practice 2

> This contradiction **weakens** the argument.

這個矛盾**削弱**了論點的說服力。

MCQ-ready definition:

weaken a position/argument = 令某立場或論點變得較難支持或較沒有說服力

23. **weakly** — 虛弱地；無力地

Practice 1

> She smiled **weakly**.

她**無力地**笑了一下。

Practice 2

> "I'm fine," he said **weakly**.

「我沒事。」他**虛弱地**說。

MCQ-ready definition:

****weakly = 以缺乏力量、精神或力度的方式****

Important distinction 1: ****weak vs weaker****

Your passage uses:

> ****weaker students****

This is comparative:

****weak → weaker → weakest****

Here ****weaker**** means:

****比較之下能力較弱****

It does not necessarily mean the students were objectively very poor; only that their academic performance was weaker relative to others.

Important distinction 2: ****weak vs bad****

****weak****

means lacking strength, quality, ability, or effectiveness.

****bad****

is a much broader negative judgment.

> weak student

能力較弱的學生

does not necessarily mean:

> bad student

壞學生 / 差學生

This distinction is particularly important in your passage.

Important distinction 3: **weak student vs lazy student**

weak student

has difficulty understanding or performing academically.

lazy student

does not make enough effort.

A weaker student may actually work very hard.

Important distinction 4: **weak vs stupid**

These are absolutely not interchangeable.

weak in a subject

means performance/ability is currently lower.

It does **not** make a judgment about intelligence.

So:

> a weaker student

should be translated naturally as:

能力較弱的學生 / 學習上較吃力的學生

not anything implying stupidity.

Important distinction 5: **weak vs vulnerable**

weak

lacks strength or effectiveness.

vulnerable

can easily be harmed or affected.

A strong person can still be vulnerable in a particular situation.

Important distinction 6: **weak vs frail**

weak

general lack of strength.

frail

physically delicate and easily harmed, often due to age or illness.

> weak muscles

肌肉無力

> a frail elderly person

身體虛弱的長者

Important distinction 7: **weak vs tired**

tired

needs rest.

weak

lacks physical strength.

You can be tired without being physically weak, and weak without feeling sleepy.

Important distinction 8: **weak argument vs wrong argument**

wrong

factually or logically incorrect.

weak

not convincing enough.

An argument can be partly correct but still weak because the evidence is poor.

Important distinction 9: **weak evidence vs little evidence**

little evidence

small quantity.

weak evidence

poor strength/reliability.

A large quantity of low-quality evidence can still be weak.

Important distinction 10: **weak signal vs poor signal**

Very close.

weak signal

specifically low signal strength.

poor signal

broader: weak, unstable, distorted, etc.

Important distinction 11: **weak tea vs thin tea**

Standard English normally says:

weak tea

= 淡茶

not usually **thin tea**.

For liquids like sauce, **thin** usually concerns texture/viscosity, while **weak** concerns

concentration/flavour.

Important distinction 12: **weak economy vs small economy**

weak economy

performing poorly.

small economy

small in total size.

A small economy can be strong, and a large economy can be weak.

Important distinction 13: **weak point vs weakness**

Very close.

weak point

specific area of weakness.

weakness

can be:

- * specific weakness

- * general state of weakness

- * personal liking in **have a weakness for**

So **weakness** is broader.

Important distinction 14: **have a weakness for ≠ be weak at**

be weak at X

= 不擅長 X

> I'm weak at maths.

我的數學較弱。

have a weakness for X

= 特別喜歡 / 很難抗拒 X

> I have a weakness for cake.

我對蛋糕很難抗拒。

Completely different.

Important distinction 15: **weakness for vs addiction**

weakness for

light, often humorous:

= strong liking.

addiction

much stronger and may refer to compulsive dependence.

So:

> a weakness for chocolate

does not normally mean addiction.

Family-extension note

Weak has a very productive semantic core:

lacking sufficient strength, power, intensity, ability, or effectiveness

That develops into several major branches:

1. **physical strength**

* weak person

* weak muscles

2. **ability/performance**

- * weak student
- * weak in maths

3. **intensity**

- * weak signal
- * weak light
- * weak tea

4. **reasoning/evidence**

- * weak argument
- * weak evidence

5. **economic/performance state**

- * weak economy
- * weak currency
- * weak sales

6. **vulnerability in structure/system**

- * weak point
- * weakness

7. **special figurative liking**

- * have a weakness for

8. **change of state**

- * weaken

The passage uses the **ability/performance** branch, not the physical one.

Master comparison

Form / expression	Traditional Chinese	Core idea
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weak student	能力較弱的學生	lower academic ability
weak at/in X	X 較弱	lower skill
weak person	虛弱的人	little physical strength

weak muscles	無力肌肉	low strength	
weak voice	微弱 / 無力聲音	low force	
weak signal	微弱訊號	low strength	
weak light	微弱光線	low intensity	
weak argument	薄弱論點	low persuasion	
weak evidence	薄弱證據	low support	
weak excuse	牽強藉口	low credibility	
weak performance	表現欠佳	low performance	
weak economy	疲弱經濟	low activity	
weak currency	疲弱貨幣	low value	
weak tea/coffee	淡茶 / 咖啡	low concentration	
weak point	弱點	vulnerable area	
weakness	弱點；虛弱	lack of strength	
weakness for X	對 X 情有獨鍾	hard to resist	
weaken X	削弱 X	reduce strength	
weaken	變弱	lose strength	
weakly	虛弱地	with little strength	

For your original sentence

> He did not show off, and he never made **weaker students** feel small.

Here:

weaker = 學業能力或表現相對較弱的

The comparative matters. It means students who were **less strong academically than others**, not necessarily students who were incapable.

And the sentence says something important about Mr Chan's character:

> he respected students regardless of ability.

A natural Traditional Chinese rendering is:

> 他不會賣弄自己，也從不令**能力較弱的學生**覺得自己很差。

For this passage, **「能力較弱的學生」** is the cleanest and most respectful translation.